

East is the new West

The Silicon Valley in the US has for long been the fountainhead of new breakthroughs in IT. Recent years have seen the rise of one more technology leader from the East – Taiwan, or as we call it, Silicon Island. The gadget-hungry world is increasingly looking at Taiwan to fulfill its demanding needs

Overheard recently in a mall

"I want to buy a cellphone with lots of features."

"Big brand or a cheap phone?"

"No! Only reputed western brands – such as HTC."

T rue, HTC is a global leader and is the manufacturer of amongst the most feature-rich phones available... but Western? Unknown to many, HTC is a brand from our very own Asian neighbour, Taiwan. The impression that all good things in technology come from Western brands, is a clichéd one. The popularity of brands such as Apple and BlackBerry have led to most Indians believing that cutting-edge developments in technology are a phenomenon of the Western world. Perhaps, there's also the tendency to visualise Asia as a mere manufacturing hub for designs, technologies and aesthetic concepts that originate in the West.

Banish the thought...

There's so much innovation happening in Asia that countries such as Taiwan, China, and even India are seeing a patent boom. In 2010, Taiwan was the third-largest filer of patents after the US and Japan, respectively.

Taiwan: the global ICT giant

The sheer amount of innovation happening in Taiwan, and the slew of feature-packed devices that Taiwanese companies release on a regular basis might prompt one to think that Silicon Valley just upped and shifted base to this little island nation. In case you didn't already know, some of the hottest brands in technology are Taiwanese – Acer, one of the leading names in notebooks, tablet PCs, smartphones; ADATA, the world's second largest vendor of DRAM modules, and third-largest for flash drives; ASUS the No. 1 manufacturer of motherboards and a soaring fourth place in consumer portable PCs; Optoma, world No. 1 manufacturer of palm-sized pico-projector; BenQ, World leader in Projectors and LCDs; Ritek, world leader in DVD storage; MSI, another leader in motherboards and graphics cards; Transcend, a household name in flash Drives, USB pen drives with the world's first "life long quaran-

tee"; Thermaltake, a world recognised cooling system brand among professional gamers are just a handful. Taiwan is at the heart of most ICT products used by technology enthusiasts in India. If you look inside your PC, you will probably find that a major part of it comes from companies based in Taiwan. Ditto with most of the other devices you own. A prime attribute for this is the fact that Taiwan ICT companies

are quick to hit the market with innovative offerings, and are backed by a robust servicing and support infrastructure. Most importantly, Taiwan ICT products believe in offering value for the price, which is a key driver for Indian consumers.

The Taiwan Govt has been initiating multiple programmes to lend support to the country's ICT industry/brands and help them compete in the global arena. One unity to the brands that stem from Taiwan is largely due to the quality symbol Taiwan Excellence.



Silicon Valley in California faces stiff competition from Taiwan, an important region in the technology space

Taiwan Excellence?

Set up in 1992, Taiwan Excellence represents the mark awarded by the Govt. Of Taiwan to companies/products with the highest standards of Innovation, Reliability and Value Worth. The Theme for Taiwan Excellence India 2011 campaign is 'India Intelligence + Taiwan Technology = IT for Excellent Lifestyles.' That the alphabets of India and Taiwan form IT, and the fact that India is reputed for software capabilities, while Taiwan is acknowledged for its hardware superiority, is a great partnership for both countries. The Organiser of Taiwan Excellence, Taiwan External Trade Development Council (TAITRA), believes that their brands/products provide the best in technology that money can buy, enabling customers to experience a truly enhanced lifestyle.

The 2011 Taiwan ICT Industry Report, published by TAITRA, showcases the rapid advances that Taiwan has made in ICT (Information and Communications Technology). The report opens with these lines, "Taiwan forms an indispensable part of the global Information and Communications Technology (ICT) industry. With roughly 57.7 per cent of global IC components coming out the Asia Pacific, the high-tech island stands at the forefront of industries including notebook computers, wafer contract foundries, IC encapsulation testing and IC



TAIWAN EXCELLENCE

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